The display packs a solid 1080x1200 screen for each eye with 90fps refresh rate. The display ratio is taller than usual at 9:5 and lets you view higher without actually moving your head up. Compared to the Oculus Rift, HTC has gone all out with the sensors in Vive, with 37 in the headset and 70 in total, including the two controllers in the package being tracked by two infrared cameras placed in two corners of the room. With this hardware in place, it is no surprise that the Vive can not only track your head movements but also where you are positioned in the room and your relative movements in the room and with respect to your hands, with an accuracy that is beyond what the comparable Oculus Rift or Playstation VR can acheive.

One of the most significant features of the Vive Pre is a frontfacing obstacle detecting camera, that works in tandem with its chaperone software to give a blue-grid on your screen where you can see the outlines of objects and people around you. Along with big gaming names like Bossa Studios, Fireproof Games, Vertigo games, HTC and Valve also have an impressive list of non-gaming content partners like HBO, Lionsgate and Google. The future for the Vive does seem promising.

Open Source in VR

Open Source Virtual Reality or OSVR is Virtual Reality's Android, with an objective to be a software framework that pushes virtual reality forward by encouraging big names to pick it up easily with a set of standards that are uniform across the industry.

It's main objective is to make it easy for the developer to dive in. Once a developer wants to create VR content, they should not have to stop and evaluate the benefits and shortcomings of each device and then chose one to create for. Compared to Oculus' device specific approach with its SDK, you can actually use OSVR's software to make content for Oculus itself right now.

On the hardware front, the device does pack in impressive specs which, even though capable of a good VR experience, are not aimed at competing with the existing names. The device at $299 comes with its own 5.5inch fullHD OLED display, but can later include a slot for a smartphone as well. Hand tracking is provided by the Leap Motion attached in front of the headset. The Vuzix iWear 720 has been made with OSVR standards and is currently up for pre-order. Needless to say, it will be compatible with future OSVR games.

Names like LeapMotion, Virtuix, Bosch, Sixense, Untold Games are already onboard and have pledged their support, along with the availability